

Real Stories: People Who've Used This Tech

Hearing from people who've actually tried this

These are real, publicly available talks and interviews. Nothing is embedded automatically, links open on YouTube in a new tab so nothing loads or tracks you until you choose to click.

This section discusses grief and bereavement

Dylan Thomas Doyle — TEDx talk on grief and AI

A personal TEDx talk exploring the emotional pull and risk of using AI to simulate a deceased loved one.

► [Watch on YouTube](#)

WIRED — "The Dadbot"

A widely-cited case study of a man who built a chatbot from his father's messages and voice before and after his father's death.

► [Watch on YouTube](#)

CNN podcast — Can griefbots help us heal?

A journalistic discussion weighing the therapeutic potential and psychological risk of AI grief companions.

► [Watch on YouTube](#)

Interview: guardianangels.ai founder and a grief therapist

A conversation about designing a bereavement-focused AI companion with safety guardrails, structured intake, and no avatar or voice until safety is validated, offered here as one example of a more cautious design approach.

► [Watch on YouTube](#)

Note: this platform is referenced as a design comparator based on this interview and public materials, and has not been independently audited to the same depth as the five major platforms in the Platform Ethics section.

What this project's own research found

COMMUNITY DISCUSSION What people already say to each other, unprompted

This project observed public discussion across three online communities (no usernames or direct quotes reproduced, per research ethics approval), and read it alongside a targeted look at how religion is discussed on general AI-companion platforms. Five patterns stood out.

- **Memory erosion, not just creation, worries people.** Several users described an AI companion gradually losing track of previously shared details about their life, experienced less as a technical glitch and more as the very continuity the tool was meant to provide quietly breaking down.
- **Response is genuinely divided, not settled.** Some described the experience in continuing-bonds terms, a supplement to grieving, even "a tombstone that talks back." Others described the same act as crossing what one post called a sacred line.
- **Consent comes up in both directions.** Retrospectively, people object to a friend recreating someone without that person's own say. Prospectively, several independently suggested people should be able to build their own AI profile in advance, consenting to it themselves before death.
- **Dependency is named openly, by users themselves.** Some described their own use becoming excessive before deliberately pulling back, and cautioned peers about over-reliance while still recognising the real comfort it gave them.
- **Religion shows up on these platforms already, unprompted.** The same AI-companion platform was seen adopting a religious identity in one conversation while its moderation flagged an ordinary religious word as sensitive in another, an inconsistency current governance has not caught up with.

SURVEY, N=80 In their own words: this project's survey respondents

These are short, anonymous, verbatim excerpts (no names, no identifying detail) from the free-text answers in this project's own 80-person survey, included with participants' consent to anonymous academic use under this project's ethics approval. They are shown here exactly as written, kept under roughly 25 words each, to give a flavour no bar chart can.

- "In Islam, the soul remains in Barzakh, and every time they are remembered or spoken about, they are aware of that presence."
- "Honour and respect them in your memory and your words."
- "I am emotionally, psychologically and spiritually opposed to it. It doesn't feel right to alter the dead's data this way."
- "It would feel like a Black Mirror episode if I was speaking to an AI of my grandpa and then had to pay to keep talking."
- "The chance to talk to my dad again."
-

"Nothing. This idea is repellent to me. I'm not saying other people shouldn't use it if they want."

"It's fascinating that it can exist, but knowing it will never be 100% them makes it less appealing."

Full statistical results, cross-tabulations, and the complete thematic analysis behind these quotes are available in this project's research notebook on request via the [Contact page](#).

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Digital Legacy Hub

A free, standalone educational tool about digital accounts, digital property, and AI simulation of people after death, and what world traditions and the law currently say about it. Not a law firm, therapy service, or product endorsement.

About this tool. This site is an accompanying artefact for a Master's capstone project submitted at the London Interdisciplinary School, researching cross-cultural ethics of AI-powered digital resurrection tools and digital legacy planning. It is an educational awareness tool first and foremost, built to help you think and talk with people you trust. **It is not a substitute for legal advice.** For a legally valid will, speak with a qualified solicitor. See the [About page](#) for the full project description.